

PDA PHONES

Motorola A760

Price: Rs 20,495

For a full-fledged PDA-cell phone combo, the Motorola A760 is worth the price tag of Rs 20,495.

The A760 comes with a USB cable to connect to a PC. You can connect the phone to a PC over the USB interface, Bluetooth or Infrared. The USB cable is provided with the phone. There's an additional connector embedded so you can connect a charger, and charge the phone while transferring files between phone and PC.



Once the phone is connected to a PC, it can be used as a GPRS modem. You can transfer contacts to and from the PC, and also copy images and video. When the complete set of utilities is installed on the PC, you can build themes using the Theme Manager, upload MP3, WAV, and MIDI files to the phone, and also synchronise contacts from the address book and calendar, and tasks from Microsoft Outlook.

Some of the functions of the phone closely resemble those of the Windows operating system. You can multitask as well—for example, you can listen to MP3s while reading SMSes. However, while multitasking, applications tend to run slow.

There are nine turbo-dial functions. The camera is not very impressive, especially when the subject is zoomed into. However, there are some good features such as brightness adjust and white level adjust. The recorder offers good playback—you will, however, have to hold the phone in the range of 4 to 5 feet of the sound source for best results.

The brightness of the backlight is adjustable.

The Motorola A760 comes with the BVR Live Update utility that downloads updates for the software from the Internet.

Sony-Ericsson P900

Price: Rs 40,000

Features such as support for e-mail with attachments and an inbuilt viewer that can read Microsoft Word, Excel, PowerPoint and PDF documents, make the P900 phone-PDA combo an excellent companion for executives on the move. However, you may want to wait till the price comes down to a more affordable level.

A worthy successor to the P800, the P900 is much better look-

ing and more professional in appearance, and nicely integrates phone and PDA functionality into one neat device. It's only marginally smaller than its predecessor, but the P900 does appear to be less chunky.

There's now video capture functionality, a small mirror for the camera at the back, and support for 65K colours. Also, the P900 has a cylindrical stylus housed in a silo and accessible from the top right.



The design of the P900 is quite business-like with a dual-tone silver-grey finish. This tri-band device boasts of all the features you would expect of a high-end smartphone. The 65K colour touch screen is 40 x 61 mm with the flip open. The internal 16 MB memory can be boosted by using the Memory Stick Duo socket that can support up to 128 MB. A 32 MB memory card is supplied along with the device. You can enter multiple pieces of data for each contact including eight phone numbers, office and home addresses, e-mail ID, URL and a note.

There are two modes the P900 can be used in—flip closed and flip open. In the flip closed mode, the P900 offers great functionality as a regular phone, with excellent voice clarity even in areas with low network coverage. The 65K colour touch screen is extremely clear and produces rich colours. When you open the flip, the LCD is fully exposed, and the phone transforms into a fully-functional PDA. The toothpick-sized stylus could be problematic: it takes some time before you get used to it. For text input, the Jot-Pro mode is very similar to Graffiti, and does not have a steep learning curve. You can use it even if you are not familiar with Graffiti.

The media functionality of the device is commendable, and music playback is quite good. Pictures captured using the camera turn out quite well, though videos are a bit grainy. You do require good lighting conditions to be able to get usable results. In terms of pure speed, the CPU seems a bit sluggish and the device feels noticeably slow while powering up and opening some applications. Playing games is not really a great experience, as there is no full screen mode, and you have to use the stylus and a virtual navigation pad to control game objects. However, opening MS Word, MS Excel, and PDF files using the Viewer application is a breeze.

You can use themes to change the interface colour scheme, and set different images as wallpapers for both the flip-open and flip-closed modes. In terms of voice features, the device boasts of voice dialling, answer or reject calls using voice commands, a voice

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